GRADE 9 ENGLISH
CONTINUOUS ASSESSMENT TEST 1

TERM 1 | TIME: 1 HOUR 15 MINUTES | TOTAL: 50 MARKS

Name: _____ Adm. No.: _____

School: _____ Date: _____

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer all questions.
- Write your answers clearly in the spaces provided or in your answer booklet.
- Read the passage carefully before answering the questions.
- The marks for each question are shown in brackets.

SECTION A: READING AND LANGUAGE USE (20 MARKS)

Read the passage below and answer questions 1–5.

THE SCHOOL GARDEN PROJECT

When the Grade Nine learners at Mwangaza Junior School noticed that part of their school compound was lying idle, they proposed turning it into a vegetable garden. Their teacher, Ms. Achieng, asked them to investigate what the project would require before beginning the work. The learners formed groups and listed the tasks: clearing the plot, preparing the soil, obtaining seeds, watering the crops and keeping records of growth.

The class consulted the school caretaker, who advised them to make raised beds because the ground became waterlogged after heavy rain. They also collected dry leaves and animal manure to prepare compost. Instead of applying too much water at once, the learners agreed to water the seedlings gently in the morning. Each group was assigned a duty, and a weekly rota was displayed on the classroom noticeboard.

At first, some seedlings wilted because they were exposed to strong afternoon sunshine. The learners discussed the problem and used locally available materials to provide temporary shade. They recorded the changes they observed and shared their findings during a class presentation. After several weeks, the garden produced vegetables that were used in the school kitchen. The project taught the learners that cooperation, careful planning and patience can turn a simple idea into a useful achievement.

1. Why did the Grade Nine learners propose starting a vegetable garden? (2 marks)

_____

2. State TWO tasks the learners listed before beginning the project. (2 marks)

_____

3. Why were raised beds recommended for the garden? (2 marks)

_____

4. Identify ONE problem the learners experienced and explain how they responded to it. (2 marks)

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5. Give TWO lessons the learners gained from the project. (2 marks)

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6. Give the meaning of each word as used in the passage: (a) idle (b) rota. (2 marks)

_____

7. Rewrite the sentence in the past tense: “The learners record the changes they observe.” (2 marks)

_____

8. Join the sentences using “although”: “The seedlings were young. The learners cared for them carefully.” (2 marks)

_____

9. Identify the parts of speech of the underlined words: “The learners worked carefully in the garden.” (2 marks)

_____

10. Punctuate the sentence correctly: ms achieng said we must work together (2 marks)

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SECTION B: WRITING (30 MARKS)

11. Write a composition of 250–300 words on the topic:
“A day when teamwork helped us solve a problem.”

Your composition should have a clear beginning, well-developed events and a suitable conclusion. Use correct grammar, spelling and punctuation. (30 marks)

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MARKING SCHEME – GRADE 9 ENGLISH CAT 1

Total: 50 marks

SECTION A: READING AND LANGUAGE USE (20 MARKS)

1. The learners noticed that part of the school compound was lying idle and wanted to use it productively by establishing a vegetable garden. (2)

2. Any TWO: clearing the plot; preparing the soil; obtaining seeds; watering crops; keeping growth records. (1 mark each)

3. The ground became waterlogged after heavy rain; raised beds would help improve drainage and protect the crops. (2)

4. The seedlings wilted in strong afternoon sunshine; learners provided temporary shade using locally available materials. (2)

5. Any TWO: cooperation/teamwork; careful planning; patience; recording and sharing observations; solving problems together. (1 mark each)

6. (a) Idle – unused/not being used. (b) Rota – a schedule or list showing who does a task and when. (1 mark each)

7. The learners recorded the changes they observed. (2 marks: correct past-tense verbs and sentence structure)

8. Although the seedlings were young, the learners cared for them carefully. (2)

9. learners – noun; carefully – adverb. (1 mark each)

10. Ms Achieng said, “We must work together.” (2 marks: capitalization and punctuation)

SECTION B: WRITING (30 MARKS)

Award marks using the following rubric. Accept any relevant, coherent composition that addresses the topic.

Assessment area	Marks	Guidance
Content and relevance	10	Clear focus on a problem solved through teamwork; relevant events and details.
Organization and development	6	Logical sequence, effective paragraphing, coherent beginning and conclusion.
Language use	8	Appropriate vocabulary, sentence variety, grammar and clarity.
Mechanics	4	Correct spelling, punctuation and capitalization.
Creativity and personal voice	2	Engaging details and an authentic voice.

Teacher’s note: This is original teacher-prepared assessment material. Confirm that the assessed language skills have been taught before administering the test. Accept equivalent correct answers.